

Virat Kohli

BIOGRAPHY, CAREER MILESTONES, AND STATISTICAL LEGACY

"Widely regarded as one of the greatest batsmen in the history of cricket, Virat Kohli has redefined precision, athletic fitness, and run-chasing in modern international sport."

80

INTERNATIONAL CENTURIES

26,000+

INTERNATIONAL RUNS

50

ODI HUNDREDS (WORLD
RECORD)

1. Early Life and Rise to Prominence

Born on November 5, 1988, in Delhi, India, Virat Kohli's cricketing journey began at the West Delhi Cricket Academy, founded in 1998. His immense raw talent first caught global attention in 2008 when he captained the Indian Under-19 cricket team to a historic victory in the ICC Under-19 Cricket World Cup in Malaysia.

Shortly after his Under-19 triumph, Kohli made his senior international debut for India in August 2008 during an ODI match against Sri Lanka. His relentless work ethic, explosive technical wristwork, and aggressive temperament rapidly established him as a staple of India's top-order batting unit.

2. Evolution of Style & The Master of Chases

Kohli's batting technique is anchored in a classic textbook framework elevated by modern power-hitting. Key elements defining his longevity include:

- **Cover Drive and Wristwork:** Exceptionally strong playing through the covers, coupled with an innate ability to flick balls from outside off-stump toward the mid-wicket boundary.
- **Physical Fitness Revolution:** Around 2012, Kohli underwent a massive physical transformation, establishing strict fitness benchmarks (including the Yo-Yo test) that altered the culture of the entire Indian national cricket ecosystem.

- **The 'Chase Master':** Kohli earned immense acclaim for his psychological resilience and execution during second-innings run chases, systematically parsing target architectures with calculated risk-taking.

3. Comprehensive Career Statistics

The statistical breakdown of Kohli across formats highlights his supreme consistency across multiple eras of global cricket:

FORMAT	MATCHES	INNINGS	RUNS	HIGHEST SCORE	AVERAGE	CENTURIES (100S)
Test Matches	115	195	8,848	254*	49.15	29
ODIs	295	283	13,906	183	58.18	50
T20Is	125	117	4,188	122*	48.69	1
IPL (T20)	252	244	8,004	113*	38.66	8

4. Captaincy and Leadership Era

Taking over the Test captaincy from MS Dhoni in late 2014, Kohli introduced an era of unmatched aggression and tactical pace-bowling dominance. Under his leadership:

- India secured its first-ever Test series win on Australian soil during the 2018–19 tour.
- The Indian Test team held the World No. 1 ranking for 42 consecutive months.
- He concluded his stint as India's most successful Test captain with 40 victories out of 68 matches.

5. Iconic Historical Milestones

1. **2011** Member of the ICC Cricket World Cup-winning Indian squad.
2. **2018** Became the fastest batsman to surpass 10,000 ODI runs, achieving the feat in just 205 innings.

3. **2023** Broken Sachin Tendulkar's legendary record by hitting his 50th ODI century during the ICC World Cup semi-final against New Zealand.
4. **2024** Announced retirement from T20 Internationals immediately after winning the ICC T20 World Cup in Barbados.